



Marketly

Pricing Strategy & Business Model
SaaS Subscription Document

Version: 1.0

Date: June 2026

Prepared by: Product & Business Team — Marketly

Document Type: Pricing Strategy & Cost Analysis

Audience: Founders · Business Team · Investor Reference

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1. Document Purpose

This document establishes the complete pricing strategy for the Marketly SaaS platform. It covers every cost component — infrastructure, APIs, third-party services, freelancer development cost, and ongoing operational cost — and derives a subscription price that is:

- **Above the floor** — covers all costs at a defined seller count
- **Below the ceiling** — competitive with comparable tools in the Indian market
- **Profitable** — recovers the total development investment within 18 months of launch
- **Clear** — leaves no ambiguity about what each plan includes, what costs are passed to sellers, and how the free trial works

Key Business Constraints

The following constraints were defined by the founders and are incorporated into every calculation in this document:

Constraint	Detail
Seller pays everything	Sellers bear 100% of subscription cost. No cost is passed to customers.
Delivery not platform-managed	Delivery is handled entirely by each seller. The platform has no delivery cost.
Two subscription tiers	Basic (app ordering only) and Premium (app + WhatsApp ordering)
WhatsApp ordering — Premium only	WhatsApp text and voice ordering is exclusively a Premium feature
Seller's own WhatsApp number	Under Premium, sellers connect their existing WhatsApp Business number (Option B)

2. Platform Overview & Subscription Models

Marketly is a **multi-tenant retail commerce SaaS platform**. Each seller gets their own isolated storefront, product catalog, order management dashboard, and customer communication channel.

Two Subscription Models

BASIC	
Customers order exclusively	
through the Marketly web app	
and Progressive Web App (PWA)	
Seller manages everything	
through their store dashboard	
PREMIUM	
Everything in Basic, PLUS:	
Customers can also order via	
the seller's WhatsApp number	

```
| using text or voice messages |  
  
| in any Indian language |  
  
| |  
  
| Orders from WhatsApp arrive in |  
  
| the seller dashboard in the exact |  
  
| same format as app orders |  
  
| |
```

Important Clarification — WhatsApp Number Ownership

Under the Premium plan, each seller connects **their own existing WhatsApp Business number** to the Marketly platform. This means:

- Customers message the **seller's own WhatsApp number** — not a Marketly number
 - The seller's brand identity is fully preserved
 - Marketly operates invisibly in the background as the processing engine
 - Each seller's customers only interact with that seller's store — there is complete isolation between stores
 - The platform connects to Meta's WhatsApp Business API under the seller's own WhatsApp Business Account
-

3. What Each Plan Includes

Basic Plan — Complete Feature Set

Feature Category	Features Included
Storefront	Unique store URL, custom branding (logo, colours, banner), PWA installable app
Product Management	Unlimited products, categories, variants, inventory tracking, low-stock alerts
Customer Ordering	Full app-based shopping experience — browse, search, cart, checkout
Order Management	Order dashboard, status updates (Placed → Confirmed → Packing → Dispatched → Delivered), order history
Payments	UPI, cards, net banking, Cash on Delivery — via Razorpay
Customer Features	Loyalty points & tiers (Bronze/Silver/Gold/Platinum), coupons & discounts, wishlist, ratings & reviews
Notifications	Push notifications, email, SMS for order updates
Analytics	Revenue dashboard, daily/weekly/monthly KPIs, top products, customer insights
Customer Support	In-app chat between customer and seller
Admin	Super admin panel for platform-level oversight

Premium Plan — Additional Features Over Basic

Feature Category	Features Included
WhatsApp Ordering	Customers can place orders by sending a WhatsApp text message to the seller's own number
Voice Ordering	Customers can send a voice note in Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, or English — the platform transcribes and processes it
WhatsApp Status Updates	Every order status change is automatically sent as a WhatsApp message to the customer
Multilingual Support	Platform detects the customer's language and responds in the same language
Reorder via WhatsApp	Customer can type "Same as last time" and reorder their previous order
WhatsApp Issue Reporting	Customers can report issues directly in the WhatsApp chat
Priority Support	Faster response SLA for Premium sellers from the Marketly support team

What is NOT Included in Either Plan

Item	Why Not Included
Delivery management	Delivery is handled entirely by each seller using their own staff
Live delivery GPS tracking	Not applicable — platform does not manage delivery agents
Delivery route optimisation	Seller's responsibility
Platform-owned customer base	Each seller's customers belong to that seller only — not shared across the platform

4. Infrastructure Cost Analysis

The platform's infrastructure is **shared across all sellers** on a single deployment. As more sellers join, the per-seller infrastructure cost decreases significantly. This is the fundamental economics of a multi-tenant SaaS platform.

Fixed Monthly Infrastructure Cost (Entire Platform)

Component	Description	Monthly Cost
Application Server	Runs all 8 microservices (4 vCPU, 16GB RAM VM or equivalent cloud instance)	₹6,000 – ₹10,000
PostgreSQL Database	Primary database with 8 schemas, automated backups, point-in-time recovery	₹3,000 – ₹5,000
Redis	Session management, OTP storage, rate limiting, caching, conversation state	₹1,000 – ₹2,000
Apache Kafka	Event streaming between microservices	₹1,500 – ₹3,000
Email (SMTP)	Transactional email via Mailgun or AWS SES	₹500 – ₹1,000
Object Storage	Product images, invoices, voice note files	₹500 – ₹1,500
Monitoring	Prometheus + Grafana (self-hosted, no additional cost)	₹0
SSL Certificates	Let's Encrypt (free) or paid wildcard cert	₹0 – ₹500
CDN	Content delivery for product images	₹500 – ₹1,000
Total Fixed Monthly		₹13,000 – ₹24,000

Working number used in calculations: ₹18,000/month

Per-Seller Infrastructure Cost at Different Scales

This table shows how the infrastructure cost per seller drops as the platform grows. This is why SaaS businesses become significantly more profitable at scale.

Active Sellers	Total Infra Cost/Month	Cost Per Seller
10 sellers	₹13,000 – ₹24,000	₹1,300 – ₹2,400
25 sellers	₹15,000 – ₹26,000	₹600 – ₹1,040
50 sellers	₹18,000 – ₹30,000	₹360 – ₹600
100 sellers	₹22,000 – ₹36,000	₹220 – ₹360
200 sellers	₹30,000 – ₹46,000	₹150 – ₹230

Key insight: At 10 sellers, infrastructure alone costs ₹1,300 – ₹2,400 per seller. At 100 sellers, it drops to ₹220 – ₹360 per seller. This is why the pricing must be set to survive the early low-seller phase while being fair at scale.

5. Variable Cost Per Seller Per Month

These costs are tied to actual seller activity and scale with usage.

Basic Plan Seller — Variable Costs

A typical Basic seller with 200–400 orders per month:

Component	What It Covers	Monthly Cost
SMS (OTP for customer logins)	~150–300 OTP SMSes per month at ₹0.20–₹0.30 each	₹30 – ₹90
Email notifications	Order confirmations, invoices, status updates	₹10 – ₹30
Object storage (product images)	~50–200 product images, invoices	₹50 – ₹150
Payment gateway	UPI = ₹0 (NPCI mandate). Cards/NB = 0.4%–1.5% (paid by customer at time of transaction, not by platform)	₹0
Total Variable — Basic Seller		₹90 – ₹270/month

Premium Plan Seller — Variable Costs (Additional)

Additional costs on top of Basic for WhatsApp ordering:

Component	What It Covers	Monthly Cost
WhatsApp conversations (Meta)	~100–300 WhatsApp ordering conversations/month at ₹0.35–₹1.17 each	₹35 – ₹350
Speech-to-Text (voice orders)	~20–30% of orders use voice; Google STT / Whisper at ₹0.50/minute	₹20 – ₹100
NLP — GPT-4o-mini	Intent extraction and order parsing at ~₹0.08 per order	₹10 – ₹40
Total Variable — Premium (Additional)		₹65 – ₹490/month

Total Variable Cost Summary

Plan	Monthly Orders	Total Variable Cost/Month
Basic	200 orders	₹90 – ₹180
Basic	400 orders	₹150 – ₹270
Premium	200 app + 100 WhatsApp orders	₹200 – ₹500
Premium	300 app + 200 WhatsApp orders	₹300 – ₹760

6. WhatsApp Feature — Detailed Cost Breakdown

This section provides complete transparency on every cost component of the WhatsApp ordering feature, which is exclusively available on the Premium plan.

6.1 Meta WhatsApp Business API

Meta charges per **conversation** (a 24-hour messaging window), not per individual message. Within one conversation window, unlimited messages can be exchanged at no additional cost.

Conversation types and pricing (India tier):

Conversation Type	When It Occurs	Cost Per Conversation
User-initiated	Customer sends the first message	~₹0.35
Business-initiated	Platform sends first message (proactive update)	~₹0.82

Free allowance: Meta provides **1,000 free user-initiated conversations per month per WhatsApp Business Account**. Since each seller connects their own WhatsApp Business Account under Option B, each seller independently benefits from this 1,000-conversation free allowance. **Cost per order lifecycle:**

- Customer messages first → user-initiated conversation (₹0.35)
- All order confirmation, packing, dispatch, delivery messages typically occur within 24 hours → covered by the same conversation window
- **Effective cost per WhatsApp order: ₹0.35 – ₹1.17**

6.2 Speech-to-Text (Voice Message Processing)

Provider	Cost	Notes
Google Cloud Speech-to-Text	Free first 60 min/month; ₹0.50/min thereafter	Excellent Hindi, Tamil, Telugu support
OpenAI Whisper API	₹0.50/min	Best multilingual accuracy for Indian languages

A typical voice order note is 10–20 seconds. Cost per voice message: ₹0.08 – ₹0.17

Monthly cost at scale:

- 100 voice messages/month: ₹8 – ₹17
- 500 voice messages/month: ₹40 – ₹85

6.3 NLP — Order Intent Extraction (OpenAI GPT-4o-mini)

The NLP layer converts natural language ("bhaiya ek litre doodh aur do bread dena") into a structured order. GPT-4o-mini is used because it offers the best cost-to-accuracy ratio for Indian language understanding.

Metric	Cost
Input tokens	\$0.15 per 1 million tokens
Output tokens	\$0.60 per 1 million tokens
Cost per WhatsApp order	₹0.06 – ₹0.10

6.4 Payment Links (Razorpay)

Razorpay charges on successful transactions, not on payment link creation.

Payment Method	Fee
UPI	₹0 (free — NPCI mandate)
Debit/Credit Card	0.40% – 1.50%
Cash on Delivery	₹0

Since the majority of Indian retail transactions are UPI or COD, the effective payment gateway cost per WhatsApp order is **₹0 for most orders**.

6.5 One-Time Setup Cost for WhatsApp Feature

Item	Cost
Meta Business Manager account	₹0 (free)
Meta Developer App creation	₹0 (free)
WhatsApp Business API access	₹0 (pay only per conversation)
Razorpay account setup	₹0 (no monthly fees)
Google Cloud / OpenAI API account	₹0 (pay per use)
Total one-time setup	₹0

6.6 Total WhatsApp Cost Per Order Summary

Cost Component	Per Order
WhatsApp conversation (Meta)	₹0.35 – ₹1.17
Speech-to-Text (25% of orders use voice)	₹0.02 – ₹0.04
NLP processing	₹0.06 – ₹0.10
Payment gateway (UPI/COD)	₹0
Total platform cost per WhatsApp order	₹0.43 – ₹1.31

Context: If an average WhatsApp order is ₹400 – ₹600, the platform's cost per order is 0.1% – 0.3% of the order value. This is extremely low and is fully absorbed in the Premium subscription margin.

7. Freelancer & Development Cost

Team Composition

The Marketly platform is being built by a team of 6 freelancers on fixed monthly retainers:

Role	Count	Monthly Retainer (Est.)
Full-stack developer (senior)	2	₹15,000 – ₹20,000 each
Full-stack developer (mid-level)	2	₹10,000 – ₹15,000 each
Designer / UI-UX	1	₹8,000 – ₹12,000
DevOps / QA	1	₹8,000 – ₹12,000
Total monthly team cost	6 people	₹66,000 – ₹94,000

Working number used in all calculations: ₹80,000/month

Current Build Status Assessment

An independent analysis of the codebase was conducted. The following table shows the completion status of each platform component:

Component	Status	% Complete
API Gateway (security, routing, JWT)	Complete	95%
Identity Service (auth, OTP, RBAC)	Complete	95%
Tenant Service (store management, KYC)	Complete	90%
Product Service (catalog, inventory)	Complete	90%
Customer Service (profiles, loyalty)	Complete	85%
Order Service (cart, checkout, orders)	Complete	85%
Notification Service (email, in-app, WebSocket)	Mostly complete — SMS stub only	80%
Analytics Service (KPIs, dashboards)	Complete	75%
Customer Storefront (app UI)	Mostly complete	80%
Seller Dashboard (admin UI)	Mostly complete	75%
Super Admin Panel	Mostly complete	70%
Auth & Seller Onboarding (7-step wizard)	Complete	90%
CI/CD Pipeline (Jenkins + Docker)	Complete	85%
SMS Gateway Integration	Not integrated (stub only)	10%
Payment Gateway (Razorpay)	Not integrated	15%
Ratings & Reviews	Mock data only	20%
Kubernetes deployment	Not built	0%
WhatsApp Ordering Service	Not started	0%
Overall Platform		~72–75%

Remaining Work to Complete

Phase 1 — Basic Plan Launch (remaining ~25%):

Work Item	Estimated Effort
Real SMS gateway integration (MSG91 / Twilio)	3–4 days
Razorpay payment gateway integration	5–7 days
Product ratings & reviews (backend + frontend)	1.5 weeks
Issue reporting & refund flow	1 week
End-to-end testing and bug resolution	2 weeks
Production deployment + domain/SSL setup	1 week
Total for Basic launch	~6–7 weeks (~1.75 months)

Phase 2 — Premium Plan Launch (WhatsApp, additional work):

Work Item	Estimated Effort
<code>whatsapp-service</code> microservice (Spring Boot)	3–4 weeks
Meta Embedded Signup flow (seller dashboard UI)	1 week
Speech-to-Text integration (Google / Whisper)	1.5 weeks
NLP order parsing (GPT-4o-mini)	1.5 weeks
Razorpay payment link in WhatsApp flow	3 days
End-to-end WhatsApp testing	1 week
Total for Premium launch	~8–9 weeks (~2 months)

8. Total Investment to Launch

Development Cost Breakdown

Phase	Duration	Monthly Team Cost	Total
Work already completed (~75% of platform)	~5 months (estimated)	₹80,000	₹4,00,000
Basic plan — remaining work	~2 months	₹80,000	₹1,60,000
Premium plan — additional work	~2 months	₹80,000	₹1,60,000
Total development cost	~9 months		₹7,20,000

All-In Investment

Cost Item	Total
Freelancer development cost (9 months)	₹7,20,000
Infrastructure during development (9 months × ₹5,000)	₹45,000
API costs during testing and development	₹15,000
Miscellaneous (domains, tools, Meta setup, Razorpay KYC)	₹20,000
Total all-in investment to full launch	₹8,00,000

This ₹8,00,000 is the total capital required to reach a fully launched product with both Basic and Premium plans live. Of this, approximately ₹4,00,000 is already spent. The remaining ₹4,00,000 covers the next 4 months of work.

9. Monthly Operating Cost After Launch

Once the platform is live, the team shifts from building to maintaining, supporting, and improving. Assume 4 freelancers are retained post-launch (2 full-stack for features and bug fixes, 1 DevOps/QA, 1 designer on reduced engagement):

Post-Launch Monthly Cost Structure

Cost Item	Monthly Cost
Retained freelancers (4 people, maintenance mode)	₹45,000 – ₹55,000
Infrastructure (servers, DB, Redis, Kafka)	₹15,000 – ₹25,000
SMS gateway (scales with active sellers)	₹2,000 – ₹6,000
Email service	₹500 – ₹1,500
Storage (product images, invoices)	₹500 – ₹2,000
WhatsApp/NLP/STT (scales with Premium sellers)	₹5,000 – ₹15,000
Support tools, monitoring, miscellaneous	₹2,000 – ₹5,000
Total monthly operating cost	₹70,000 – ₹1,09,500

Working number: ₹85,000/month (used in all profitability calculations)

10. Final Subscription Pricing

Pricing Derivation Logic

The pricing was determined by working from three inputs simultaneously:

1. **Floor (cost-based):** What is the minimum revenue needed to cover operating costs at a viable seller count?
2. **Ceiling (market-based):** What do comparable Indian SaaS tools charge?
3. **Recovery (investment-based):** At what price does the ₹8,00,000 investment recover within 18 months?

The Prices

BASIC PLAN — ₹1,999 per month

Annual option: ₹19,990 per year (equivalent to ₹1,666/month — saving ₹2,398 vs monthly) **What is included:**

- Your own store URL (marketly.com/s/your-store-name)
- Unlimited product listings with variants, categories, and inventory management
- Full customer shopping experience — browse, search, cart, checkout
- Order management dashboard with complete order lifecycle management
- UPI, card, net banking, and Cash on Delivery payments via Razorpay
- Customer loyalty points and tier system (Bronze → Silver → Gold → Platinum)
- Coupons, discount codes, flash deals, and combo offers
- Product ratings and customer reviews
- Push notifications, SMS, and email for all order events
- Real-time analytics dashboard — revenue, orders, top products, customer metrics
- In-app customer-to-seller chat support
- Progressive Web App (PWA) — customers can install the store as an app without the App Store or Play Store
- Seller branding — custom logo, colours, banner
- Super admin oversight and KYC approval

What is NOT included in Basic:

- WhatsApp ordering (text or voice)
 - WhatsApp status update messages to customers
-

PREMIUM PLAN — ₹3,999 per month

Annual option: ₹39,990 per year (equivalent to ₹3,333/month — saving ₹5,998 vs monthly) **What is included:**

- **Everything in the Basic plan**, plus:
- WhatsApp ordering via the seller's own WhatsApp number
- Customers can place orders by sending a text message in any Indian language
- Customers can send a voice note — the platform transcribes and processes it automatically
- The system understands Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, and English
- Orders from WhatsApp appear in the seller's dashboard in identical format to app orders
- Automatic WhatsApp messages to customers at every order status change
- "Same as last time" reorder shortcut via WhatsApp
- Issue reporting and refund requests via WhatsApp
- Priority customer support response from the Marketly team

Key clarification on WhatsApp number:

Under the Premium plan, each seller connects their own existing WhatsApp Business number to Marketly. Customers message the seller's own number — not a Marketly-owned number. The seller's customer relationship is fully preserved and Marketly operates invisibly in the background.

Annual Pricing — Why It Matters

Plan	Monthly Billing	Annual Billing	Annual Saving
Basic	₹1,999/month	₹19,990/year (₹1,666/month)	₹2,398
Premium	₹3,999/month	₹39,990/year (₹3,333/month)	₹5,998

Annual plans benefit the seller (saves money) and benefit Marketly (upfront cash improves cash flow and reduces churn risk). Sellers who pay annually are committed for 12 months and are significantly less likely to cancel.

Recommendation: Always offer annual billing as the primary option on the pricing page. Show the monthly equivalent price prominently ("₹1,666/month, billed annually").

11. Revenue & Profitability Projections

Scenario 1 — Conservative (Mostly Basic Sellers)

Month	Basic Sellers	Premium Sellers	Monthly Revenue	Monthly Cost	Monthly Profit/Loss
Month 1–2 (launch)	5	0	₹9,995	₹85,000	–₹75,005
Month 3	12	2	₹31,986	₹87,000	–₹55,014
Month 4	20	4	₹55,974	₹89,000	–₹33,026
Month 6	35	8	₹101,957	₹93,000	+₹8,957
Month 9	55	15	₹169,920	₹98,000	+₹71,920
Month 12	75	20	₹229,875	₹1,05,000	+₹1,24,875

Scenario 2 — Realistic (Balanced Mix)

Month	Basic Sellers	Premium Sellers	Monthly Revenue	Monthly Cost	Monthly Profit/Loss
Month 1–2	5	0	₹9,995	₹85,000	–₹75,005
Month 3	15	5	₹49,970	₹88,000	–₹38,030
Month 5	30	12	₹107,838	₹92,000	+₹15,838
Month 7	45	18	₹161,808	₹96,000	+₹65,808
Month 10	60	25	₹219,825	₹1,02,000	+₹1,17,825
Month 12	75	30	₹269,775	₹1,08,000	+₹1,61,775

Scenario 3 — Optimistic (Strong Premium Adoption)

Month	Basic Sellers	Premium Sellers	Monthly Revenue	Monthly Cost	Monthly Profit/Loss
Month 3	15	8	₹61,967	₹89,000	–₹27,033
Month 5	30	18	₹131,952	₹93,000	+₹38,952
Month 8	50	30	₹219,870	₹1,00,000	+₹1,19,870
Month 12	70	45	₹319,755	₹1,12,000	+₹2,07,755

12. Break-Even Analysis

Break-even is the point where monthly revenue equals monthly operating cost (₹85,000).

Break-Even Points

Seller Mix	Monthly Revenue	vs ₹85,000 Cost
43 Basic, 0 Premium	₹85,957	✓ Break-even
30 Basic, 10 Premium	₹99,960	✓ Break-even
20 Basic, 17 Premium	₹107,903	✓ Break-even
42 Basic, 0 Premium	₹83,958	✗ Just below

The critical milestone is 40–43 total sellers. At any mix that totals approximately 43 sellers (or fewer if more are on Premium), the platform covers its monthly operating cost entirely.

Why This Number is Achievable

43 sellers across all Indian cities is a very small number for a platform that serves independent retailers. A single city (Bangalore, Mumbai, Delhi, Chennai, Hyderabad) has tens of thousands of independent grocery stores, bakeries, pharmacies, and organic shops that currently have no digital ordering capability and no WhatsApp integration.

The target of 43 sellers to break even is a conservative, achievable milestone within 6–8 months of launch.

13. Free Trial Model

The Trial Offer

Both plans offer a 30-day free trial.

- No credit card required to start the trial
- Full access to all features of the chosen plan during the trial
- Trial applies to the first subscription only (not available on renewal or plan switches)

Why a Free Trial is Essential

A seller who has not yet seen orders come through the platform has no evidence of value. Asking them to pay ₹1,999 or ₹3,999 upfront without proof is a friction point that kills conversion.

A 30-day trial solves this decisively:

1. The seller sets up their store (products, branding, categories)
2. They share their store URL or WhatsApp number with existing customers
3. Within the first week, orders start coming in
4. The seller now has evidence: real orders, real revenue, real customers using the platform
5. At day 30, paying ₹1,999 or ₹3,999/month is an easy decision — they are already generating value

Industry data: SaaS platforms that offer free trials convert 60–80% of trial users to paid subscribers if the trial results in at least one successful outcome (in this case, one real order).

Trial Rules — What Is and Is Not Allowed

Rule	Detail
Duration	30 days from account activation
Credit card	Not required to start
Features	Full plan features — no artificial restrictions
Eligible accounts	First-time sellers only. One trial per phone number / business registration
After trial	Subscription must be activated to continue. Store goes into read-only mode if subscription is not activated within 7 days after trial ends
Grace period	7-day grace period after trial ends — store remains accessible but order placement is disabled. Seller is notified on day 25, 28, and 30
WhatsApp during trial	Premium trial sellers can connect their WhatsApp number and test the ordering flow with real customers during the trial period

Trial Communication Timeline

Day	Action
Day 1	Welcome email + setup guide sent to seller
Day 7	"Your trial is going well — here's how to get your first orders" email
Day 15	Mid-trial check-in — "You've had X orders so far"
Day 25	"5 days left in your trial — activate your subscription" warning
Day 28	Second activation reminder
Day 30	Trial ends — grace period begins
Day 37	Grace period ends — store goes read-only

What Happens After Trial if Seller Does NOT Subscribe

- Store is put into **read-only mode**: seller can see their data but customers cannot place new orders
- Store URL shows a "This store is temporarily unavailable" message to customers

- Seller's data is retained for 90 days — they can reactivate at any time by subscribing
- After 90 days of inactivity: account is marked for deletion with a 30-day final notice

No Hidden Costs During Trial

There are zero costs to the seller during the 30-day trial. Marketly absorbs:

- All infrastructure costs
- All SMS costs (OTP for customer logins)
- All email notification costs
- All WhatsApp conversation costs (Premium trial)
- All NLP and STT costs (Premium trial)

This is intentional — the trial period is a customer acquisition cost for Marketly, not a revenue opportunity.

14. Investment Recovery Timeline

Total Investment: ₹8,00,000

This must be recovered through subscription profits after covering monthly operating costs.

Recovery Calculation (Realistic Scenario)

Period	Cumulative Profit	Investment Recovered
Months 1–3 (loss phase)	–₹1,50,000	0%
Months 4–6	–₹60,000 net	0%
Month 7	+₹65,808/month	Beginning recovery
Month 9	+₹95,000/month	₹2,00,000 recovered
Month 12	+₹1,61,775/month	₹5,50,000 recovered
Month 15	+₹2,00,000/month	₹8,00,000+ recovered 

Full investment recovery: Month 15 (15 months after launch)

What "Recovery" Means in Practice

Recovery does not mean the business stops generating losses first. The timeline works as follows:

- **Months 1–4:** Monthly losses (₹30,000 – ₹75,000/month) as seller base grows. These losses are funded from the ₹4,00,000 remaining development budget which covers both remaining development AND early operational losses.
- **Month 5–6:** Break-even zone. Monthly losses reduce to near zero.
- **Month 7 onwards:** Monthly profits begin. These profits are used to recover the ₹8,00,000 sunk investment.
- **Month 15:** Full recovery achieved. Every rupee from month 16 onwards is retained profit.

Sensitivity: What If Growth is Slower?

Growth Scenario	Break-Even Month	Full Recovery Month
Slow (5 sellers/month acquisition)	Month 9	Month 22
Realistic (8–10 sellers/month)	Month 6	Month 15
Fast (15 sellers/month)	Month 4	Month 10

Even in the slowest scenario, the investment is fully recovered within 22 months — well within a standard business planning horizon.

15. Additional Revenue Levers

These are optional revenue streams that can be activated after the core subscription model is stable. None of these are required to reach profitability — they are upside opportunities.

Revenue Stream	Description	When to Activate
Transaction fee	0.5% on monthly GMV above ₹1,00,000 per seller	After 100 sellers
One-time setup fee	₹2,999 onboarding fee (waived for first 50 sellers as a launch promotion)	At launch (optional)
Extra staff accounts	Base plan includes 2 staff accounts. Additional accounts: ₹299/account/month	Month 3 onwards
Custom domain mapping	Seller maps their own domain (janesbakery.com) to their Marketly store: ₹499/month add-on	Month 6 onwards
SMS top-up credits	Sell SMS credits above the included monthly bundle	Month 6 onwards
Promoted listings	Sellers pay to feature products at the top of category pages	Month 9 onwards

Policy on additional revenue: None of these levers should be activated before the seller base reaches 50 and before the core product is stable. Introducing add-on costs too early damages trust and increases churn.

16. Market Benchmarking

Comparable Indian SaaS Tools — What They Charge

Platform	What It Does	Monthly Price
Dukaan	Basic online store builder	₹999 – ₹2,499/month
Instamojo	Online store + payments	₹999 – ₹2,499/month
Zoho Commerce	E-commerce + inventory	₹1,099 – ₹2,299/month
Shopify India	Full e-commerce suite	₹1,994 – ₹7,447/month
Interakt	WhatsApp Business API tool (only)	₹2,499 – ₹6,999/month
Wati	WhatsApp Business API tool (only)	₹2,999 – ₹7,999/month
AiSensy	WhatsApp marketing + ordering	₹2,499 – ₹5,999/month
Petpooja / UrbanPiper	Restaurant-specific commerce	₹3,000 – ₹8,000/month

Marketly's Value vs Market

Basic plan at ₹1,999:

Dukaan and Instamojo charge ₹999 – ₹2,499 for a significantly simpler product with no multi-tenancy, no loyalty system, no analytics, and no real-time notifications. Marketly at ₹1,999 is priced at the midpoint of this range while offering a far superior product.

Premium plan at ₹3,999:

WhatsApp-only tools (Interakt, Wati, AiSensy) charge ₹2,499 – ₹7,999/month — for WhatsApp alone, with no store, no inventory, no ordering system. Marketly Premium at ₹3,999 gives sellers a complete commerce platform AND WhatsApp ordering. The value comparison is decisive.

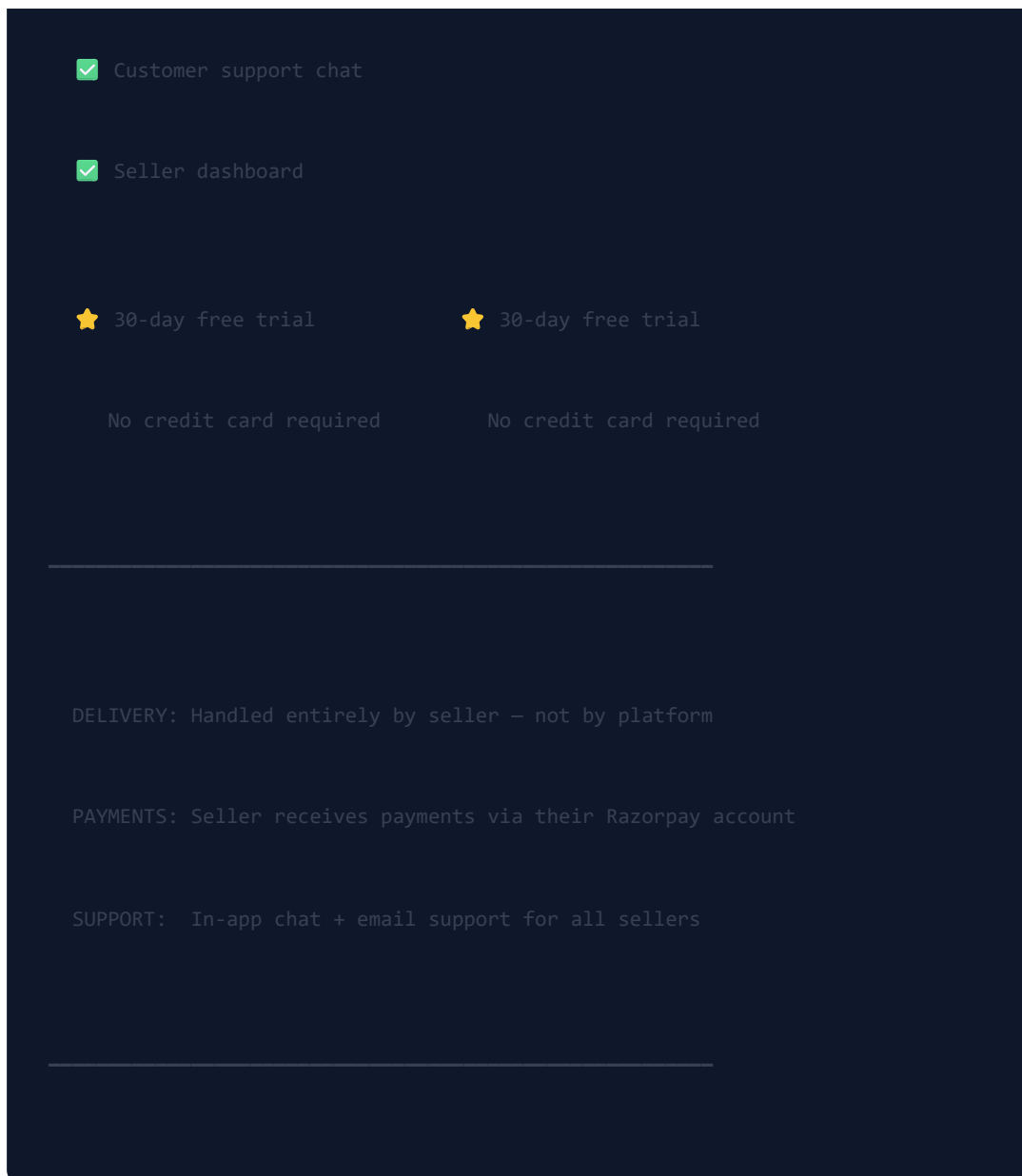
A seller who wants both a store platform AND WhatsApp ordering would spend:

- Dukaan (₹1,999) + Interakt (₹2,499) = **₹4,498/month** for two separate tools
- Marketly Premium = **₹3,999/month** — everything integrated, one bill, one platform

17. Pricing Summary Card

This is the clean, simple version of the pricing — suitable for the website, sales deck, and seller onboarding material.

MARKETLY SUBSCRIPTION PLANS	
BASIC	PREMIUM
₹1,999/month	₹3,999/month
₹19,990/year (save ₹2,398)	₹39,990/year (save ₹5,998)
✓ Your own store URL ✓ Unlimited products ✓ Order management ✓ Customer app + PWA ✓ UPI + Card + COD ✓ Loyalty points & tiers ✓ Coupons & discounts ✓ Analytics dashboard ✓ Push + SMS + email alerts ✓ Ratings & reviews	✓ Everything in Basic ✓ WhatsApp ordering (text + voice) ✓ Hindi/Tamil/Telugu/ Kannada support ✓ WhatsApp order updates ✓ Connect your own WhatsApp number ✓ Priority support



Key Numbers at a Glance

Metric	Value
Total investment to full launch	₹8,00,000
Already invested (estimated)	₹4,00,000
Remaining investment needed	₹4,00,000
Monthly operating cost post-launch	₹85,000
Basic plan price	₹1,999/month
Premium plan price	₹3,999/month
Break-even seller count	~43 sellers (any mix)
Expected break-even month	Month 5–6 after launch
Full investment recovery	Month 15 after launch
Free trial duration	30 days, no credit card
WhatsApp cost per order (platform cost)	₹0.43 – ₹1.31
Target profit at 75 Basic + 30 Premium	₹1,61,775/month

End of Document **Document Version:** 1.0 **Prepared:** June 2026 **Next Review:** September 2026 (or when seller count reaches 25)